

Static GK Test -17

Q1. Who among the following was a popular music director in India?

- A) Birju Maharaj
- B) Bappi Lahiri**
- C) Kaifi Azmi
- D) Anjaan

Solution: 5.(b) Bappi Lahiri. 2017 - Banga Bhushan Civilian Honour by Government of West Bengal. Birju Maharaj (Lucknow “Kalka-Bindadin” Gharana, Kathak Dancer). Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1964), Padma Vibhushan (1986), Kalidas Samman (1987). Kaifi Azmi (Urdu Poet, Lyricist, songwriter). Anjaan (Lalji Pandey) was an lyricist known for his work in Hindi language films.

Q2. With reference to Sonepur Cattle fair, consider the following statements and select the correct option. a) It is associated with the Hariharnath temple. b) It begins on Purnima (full moon night) and Kartik month. c) It is celebrated in the Madhya Pradesh state.

- A) Both a and b**
- B) Both a and c
- C) Both b and c
- D) a, b, c

Solution: 1.(a) Both a and b. Sonepur Cattle Fair is one of Asia's largest cattle fairs, organized at the confluence of two rivers, the Ganga and Gandak in Bihar. Nagaji Fair is celebrated in the tribal area of Madhya Pradesh. Other Important fairs - Pushkar (Rajasthan), Hemis Gompa (Ladakh), Surajkund (Haryana).

Q3. Which among the following dances is also known as Ekaharya, where one dancer takes on many roles in a single performance?

- A) Bharatnatyam**
- B) Kuchipudi
- C) Kathakali
- D) Kathak

Solution: 12.(a) Bharatnatyam. It originated in the temples of South India, particularly, Tamil Nadu. It used to be performed by Devadasis, thus it was also known as Dasiattam. Bharatanatyam artists - Mrinalini Sarabhai, Shobhana, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Padma Subrahmanyam, Chithra Vishveshwaran, etc. Indian classical dances - Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kathakali, Kuchipudi, Odissi, Sattriya, Manipuri, Mohiniyattam, Chhau.

Q4. Which among the following is India's first Human spaceflight programme?

- A) Shukrayaan
- B) Gaganyaan**
- C) Mangalyaan
- D) Chandrayaan - 1

Solution: 9.(b) Gaganyaan - It envisages demonstration of human spaceflight capability. It will be launched at the end of 2023 or in 2024. Mars Orbiter Mission (MOM, Mangalyaan): Launch vehicle - PSLV-C25, Date - 5 November 2013. Chandrayaan-1 (India's first moon mission): Launched on - 22 October 2008. Place - SDSC SHAR (Sriharikota). Chandrayaan-2: Launched on - 22 July 2019. Launch vehicle - GSLV MkIII-M1. Chandrayaan - 3 : Launched on - 14 July 2023. Launch vehicle - LVM3 M4.

Q5. Which Indian dancer won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Odissi Dance in 2018 ?

- A) Dr. Aruna Mohanty
- B) Akham Lakshmi Devi
- C) Surupa Sen**
- D) Elam Endira Devi

Solution: 2.(c) Surupa Sen. Sangeet Natak Akademi Award: Aruna Mohanty (2010, Odissi Dancer), Akham Lakshmi Devi (2018, Manipuri Dancer). Elam Endira Devi {Padma Shri (2014), Manipuri Dancer}. Sangeet Natak Akademi Award was established in 1952.

Q6. Simone Biles is associated with which sports?

- A) Swimming

- B) Badminton
- C) Gymnastics**
- D) Table tennis

Solution: 2.(c) Gymnastics. Simone Biles (USA) holds the record for winning the most medals (25 total) at the World Championship and 4 Gold medals in 2016 Olympics. Famous Sports Players - Swimming - Michael Phelps, Arati Saha, Bhakti Sharma. Badminton - PV Sindhu, Saina Nehwal, Lin Dan. Table tennis - Manika Batra, Neha Aggarwal, Zhang Jike.

Q7. Consider the following statements in context to Dollu Kunitha dance. Select the correct statements. a) It is a popular dance of Karnataka. b) Drums are adorned with colourful clothes. c) Religious and battle fervor songs are sung.

- A) Only a
- B) a, b, c**
- C) Only a, b
- D) Only b, c

Solution: 4.(b) Dollu Kunitha is an integral part of various temple festivals, cultural events and celebrations. Karaga festival procession, Mysuru Dasara, Jambu Savari, Bengaluru Habba, various temple car festivals often include Dollu Kunitha performances. Dances of Karnataka - Bhoota or Kola, Balakat. Festival of Karnataka - Hampi, Kambala, Negilu, Hagga, Vairamudi, Huthri.

Q8. In 2006, Ileana Citaristi, an Italian Odissi dancer, was awarded with the _____.

- A) Padma Bhushan
- B) Bharat Ratna
- C) Padma Shri**
- D) Padma Vibhushan

Solution: 2.(c) Padma Shri. Ileana Citaristi won the Best Choreography prize at the 43rd National Film Awards in 1995 for Yugant. Other Odissi Dancer - Kumkum Mohanty, Sonal Mansingh (Bharatanatyam as well), Kiran Segal, Pankaj Charan Das (Father of Odissi Dance), Mayadhar Raut, Gangadhar Pradhan.

Q9. Ustad Allaiddin Khan, a famous Indian musician is associated with _____ musical instrument.

- A) Surbahar
- B) Santoor
- C) Sarod**
- D) Sitar

Solution: 11.(c) Sarod. Ustad Allaiddin Khan: Awards - Padma Bhushan (1958), Padma Vibhushan (1971), Sangeet Natak Akademi (1954). Other players of Sarod: Amjad Ali Khan, Ali Akbar Khan, Brij Narayan, Hafiz Ali Khan, Arnab Chakrabarty, and Partho Sarothy.

Q10. Which famous Indian sportsman is nicknamed as 'Captain Cool' ?

- A) Mahendra Singh Dhoni**
- B) Major Dhyan Chand
- C) Milkha Singh
- D) Rohit Sharma

Solution: 6.(a) Mahendra Singh Dhoni (Thala, mahi). Other players nicknames :- Sachin Tendulkar (Master Blaster and God of cricket), Mary Kom (Magnificent Mary), Milkha Singh (Flying sikh), Rohit Sharma (Hitman), Major Dhyan Chand (Hockey wizard), Sunil Gavaskar (Little Master), Kapil Dev (Haryana Hurricane), Virat Kohli (Chikoo), Saurav Ganguly - Dada, Prince of Kolkata. Rahul Dravid (The Wall), Yuvraj Singh (Yuvi), Anil Kumble (Jumbo).

Q11. Lotia is a regional music form of which state ?

- A) Odisha
- B) Rajasthan**
- C) Assam
- D) Bihar

Solution: 14.(b) Rajasthan. Lotia - It is sung by the peasants while working in the fields on the occasion of Lotia festival in the Chaitra month according to the Hindu calendar. Women bring lotas (a vessel to fill water) and kalash (a vessel considered to be auspicious to fill water during worship) filled with water from ponds and wells. Traditional Folk Music of Rajasthan - Pabuji Ki Phach, Maand, Panihari.

Q12. Nati is a folk dance of which of the following states?

- A) Himachal Pradesh**
- B) Madhya Pradesh
- C) Arunachal Pradesh
- D) Andhra Pradesh

Solution: 6.(a) Himachal Pradesh. Nati - It was listed in the Guinness Book of World Records as the largest folk dance in the world. It is known as Tandi in upper districts of Garhwal. Other folk dances : Himachal Pradesh - Rakshasa (demon), Kayang, Bakayang, the Bnayangchu, the Jataru Kayang, Chohara, Shand and Shabu, Lang-dar-ma, Jhanjhar, Jhoor, Gi, and Rasa; MadhyaPradesh - Jawara, Matki, Aada, Khada Nach; AndhraPradesh - Bhamakalapam, Veeranatyam, Dappu; Arunachal Pradesh - Bhuiya, Chalo, Wancho.

Q13. Which among the famous novels written by Indian author R. K. Narayan?

- A) The dark room**
- B) The Suitable boy
- C) Unaccustomed Earth
- D) Half Girlfriend

Solution: 8.(a) The dark room. R. K. Narayan: Novels - “Swami and Friends”, “The Bachelor of Arts”, “The Dark Room”, “The English Teacher”, “Mr. Sampath”. Awards - Sahitya Akademi Award (1960), Padma Bhushan (1964), AC Benson Medal by the (British) Royal Society of Literature (1980), Rajyotsava Prashasti (1986). Famous Books - “The Suitable Boy” - Vikram Seth, “Unaccustomed Earth” - Jhumpa Lahiri, “Half Girlfriend” - Chetan Bhagat.

Q14. Barash is similar to the hindu festival Diwali, which is celebrated by which of the following tribes ?

- A) Varli and Kokna**
- B) Santhal
- C) Munda
- D) Gond and Bhil

Solution: 5.(a) Varli and Kokna (Western India). India Tribal Festivals: Madai Festival (Gond tribe), Nagaji Festival (Bhil tribe), Bhagoriya festival (Bhil and Bhilala tribes), Karma festival (Oraon, Munda tribe).

Q15. 'I2U2' initiative is also referred as _____ .

- A) East European Quad
- B) West European Quad
- C) West Asian Quad**
- D) East Asian Quad

Solution: 13.(c) West Asian Quad. I2U2 (India, Israel, United States and United Arab Emirates) : Formed - October 2021, First summit - July 14, 2022. Objective - Six areas of cooperation have been identified by the countries mutually to encourage joint investments in water, energy, transportation, space, health, and food security.

Q16. Roger Federer is a famous player of _____ sport.

- A) Rugby
- B) Lawn Bowls
- C) Football
- D) Lawn Tennis**

Solution: 15.(d) Lawn Tennis. Highest governing body - International Tennis Federation (1913). Famous Players : Tennis - Rafael Nadal, Novak Djokovic, Serena Williams, Sania Mirza, Leander Paes, Rohan Bopanna. Rugby - Jonah Lomu, Dan Carter, Richie McCaw, Gautam Dagar. Football - Lionel Messi, Cristiano Ronaldo, Johan Cruyff, Neymar. Lawn Bowls - Jason Greenslade, Willie Wood.

Q17. Which of the following Indian classical dancers was the recipient of the Padma Vibhushan award of 2003?

- A) Saswati Sen
- B) Elam Endira Devi
- C) Birju Maharaj
- D) Sonal mansingh**

Solution: 15.(d) Sonal Mansingh : Indian classical dancer in Bharatanatyam and Odissi dancing style. Award - Padma Bhushan (youngest recipient) (1992), Lifetime Achievement Award (2019). Other dancers and awards : Saswati Sen (Kathak dancer) - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2004-05). Pandit Birju Maharaj (Kathak dancer) - Padma Vibhushan (1986), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1964), Kalidas Samman (1987), Lata Mangeshkar Puruskar (2002). Elam Endira Devi (dance form of Manipuri) - Padma Shri (2014).

Q18. The Sangeet Natak Akademi is India's national academy for music, dance and drama. It was created by a resolution of the (then) _____, Government of India, in 1952 with Dr P.V. Rajamannar as its first Chairman.

- A) Ministry of Transportation
- B) Ministry of Art
- C) Ministry of Education**
- D) Ministry of dances

Solution: 9.(c) Ministry of Education. The Sangeet Natak Akademi was created by a resolution of the Ministry of Education on 31 May 1952 and was officially notified in the Gazette of India in June 1952. The Akademi was inaugurated by the first President of India, Dr. Rajendra Prasad, on 28 January 1953. During its inauguration, Maulana Abul Kalam Azad was serving as the Union Minister for Education. At present, it comes under the Ministry of Culture.

Q19. The IAAF World Championships in Athletics became a fully professional competition from _____.

- A) 1997**
- B) 1995
- C) 1993
- D) 1991

Solution: 4.(a) 1997. World Athletics was formerly known as the International Amateur Athletic Federation and International Association of Athletics Federations (IAAF). It is the international governing body for the sport of athletics, covering track and field, cross country running, road running, race walking, mountain running, and ultra running. Formation - 1912. Headquarters - Monaco. President (as of July 2024) - Sebastian Coe.

Q20. Which sport is played by the Indian sportsperson Leander Paes ?

- A) Badminton
- B) Table Tennis
- C) Cricket
- D) Lawn Tennis**

Solution: 15.(d) Lawn Tennis. Leander Paes was the first Indian who had won a Singles Bronze medal at the Atlanta Olympic Games in 1996. Awards: Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna award (1996–97), Arjuna Award (1990), Padma Shri award (2001). Other Indian Tennis players: Sania Mirza, Rohan Bopanna, Mahesh Bhupathi, and Ramanathan Krishnan (First Asian player to win the Wimbledon boys singles title in 1954).

Q21. The Nehru Trophy competition near Alappuzha, held on the second Saturday of August every year, is the most competitive and popular of the _____category.

- A) badminton
- B) basketball
- C) boat races**
- D) horse races

Solution: 8.(c) boat races. The Nehru Trophy Boat Race takes place at Punnamada Lake, near Alappuzha. Other boat races in Kerala: Champakkulam Boat Race, Payippad Boat Race, Aranmula Boat Race, Kottapuram Boat Race, etc.

Q22. In which of the following states of India is the festival Bonalu

celebrated ?

- A) West Bengal
- B) Tamil Nadu
- C) Assam
- D) Telangana**

Solution: 10.(d) Telangana. Bonalu is a Hindu festival dedicated to the worship of Goddess Mahakali. It is celebrated annually in Hyderabad, Secunderabad, and other parts of Telangana. Other festivals of Telangana : Peerla Panduga, Sammakka Saarakka Jaathara, and Bathukamma.

Q23. Chaitrual and Phulaich are the festival of which of the following states ?

- A) Himachal Pradesh**
- B) Gujarat
- C) Uttarakhand
- D) Haryana

Solution: 7.(a) Himachal Pradesh. Chaitrual (festival of pictures) - celebrated in the month of Chaitra (March - April) in Sirmaur area. Phulaich (festival of flowers)- celebrated on the 16th day of the Hindu month of Bhadrapada (August - September). States and their festivals : Himachal Pradesh - Pori Festival, Minjar Fair, Halda Festival, Losar Festival. Haryana - Teej, Guga Navmi, Gangore Festival. Uttarakhand - Basant Panchami, Bhिताuli, Harela, Phooldei, Batsavitri, Ganga Dussehra, Dikar Puja. Gujarat - Navratri, Uttarayan, Rann Utsav, Shamlaji Melo.

Q24. In Badminton, the length and width of the doubles court shall be of_____.

- A) 12.20 m × 6.20 m
- B) 13.40 m x 6.10 m**
- C) 13.40 m x 5.20 m
- D) 13.20 m × 6.50 m

Solution: 7.(b) 13.40 m x 6.10 m. For singles the court is marked 5.18m wide. The lines marking out the court are easily distinguishable and coloured white or yellow. The lines are 40mm wide. The back boundary lines - become the long service lines and the posts or the strips of material representing them are placed on the side lines. The diagonal full length of the full court is 14.366m. Basketball court - 91.86 ft long and 49.21ft wide. Table tennis - dimension of 274 cm long and 152.5 cm wide.

Q25. Who is credited with creating the popular Raga Miya Ki Malhar?

- A) Tansen**
- B) Amir Khusrau
- C) Meera Bai
- D) Zakir Hussain

Solution: 12.(a) Tansen. Compositions - Darbari Kanhra (night raga), Mian Ki Todi (morning raga), Mian ki Sarang (mid-day raga). Miya ki Malhar (seasonal raga). Zakir Hussain - An Indian tabla player, composer, percussionist and music producer. Amir Khusrau (founder of qawwali). He was a famous musician in the court of Alauddin Khalji. Meera Bai (Devotee of Krishna) - Bhajans and Raga composed by her - Raag Govind, Govind Tika, Raag Soratha, Meera Ki Malhar, Mira Padavali, Narsi ji Ka Mayara.

Q26. According to Census of India 2011, which district in India has the lowest literacy rate?

- A) Chowki
- B) Alirajpur**
- C) Bemetara
- D) Siwan

Solution: 12.(b) Alirajpur. According to the Census 2011, Male Literacy of Alirajpur is 42.02% while female literacy stands at 31.10%. Serchhip (Mizoram) was the most literate district in India as per Census 2011. The national literacy rate in the country is 74.04%. The literacy rate among males is 82.14%. The literacy rate among females is 65.46%. Kerala retained the top with a 94% literacy rate. Bihar ranks last in the overall ranking with a 61.80% literacy rate.

Q27. Which of the following erstwhile Princely states was primarily associated with Kathak?

- A) Tripura

- B) Avadh**
- C) Baroda
- D) Vijaynagar

Solution: 8.(b) Avadh. Kathak (Uttar Pradesh) - It was performed under the Mughal emperors. Exponents - Pandit Birju Maharaj, Shovna Narayan, Shambhu Maharaj, Lachhu Maharaj. Other dances of Uttar Pradesh: Charkula, Khyal, Rasilila, Nautanki Dance, Kajri. Tripura - Hojagiri, Garia, Jhum, Bijhu, Sangrai, Lebang boomani.

Q28. Laho is the dance form of which state?

- A) Manipur
- B) Sikkim
- C) Meghalaya**
- D) Kerala

Solution: 14.(c) Meghalaya. Laho Dance : Performed during the Behdienkhlam festival by the Jaintia tribe. Other dances of Meghalaya : Nongkrem, Shad Suk Mynsiem, Wangala and Dorsegata. Dances of other states : Manipur - Pung Cholom, Lai Haraoba, Thang Ta, Nupa pala. Sikkim - Yak cham, Mask dance, Lu Khangthamo and Singhi chham. Kerala - Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Thiruvathirakali, Kolkali, Koodiyattam and Theyyam.

Q29. 'Freedom in Exile' is the autobiographical book of_____.

- A) Jawaharlal Nehru
- B) Mahatma Gandhi
- C) J.B. Kriplani
- D) Dalai Lama**

Solution: 3.(d) Dalai Lama. The Dalai Lama wrote two autobiographies; the first was 'My Land And My People' and the second was 'Freedom in Exile'. More books by him:- "The Art of Happiness", "The Book of Joy", "Ancient Wisdom, Modern World", "Beyond Religion". Jawaharlal Nehru - "Toward freedom" (autobiographical book). Mahatma Gandhi - "My Experiments with Truth". J B Kripalani - "My Times" (autobiographical book).

Q30. Bhimsen Joshi belongs to which of the following classical music traditions?

- A) Delhi Gharana
- B) Banaras Gharana
- C) Kirana Gharana**
- D) Jaipur Gharana

Solution: 13.(c) Kirana gharana : Founder - Ustad Abdul Karim Khan. Famous artists - Suresh Babu Mane, Hira Bai Badodekar and Roshanara Begum. Bhimsen Joshi Awards - Bharat Ratna (2009), Padma Vibhushan (1999), Padma Bhushan (1985), Padma Shri (1972). Gharana and Founder: Banaras - Ram Sahai. Jaipur Gharana - Bhanuji.

Q31. The Rangaswami Cup is associated with sports _____.

- A) Football
- B) Hockey**
- C) Tennis
- D) Badminton

Solution: 6.(b) Hockey. The Rangaswami Cup was first held in 1928 as an Inter-Provincial Tournament to select players for the national team for the Olympics. Other Hockey Trophies and Cups - Agha Khan Cup, Dhyan Chand Trophy, Azlan Shah Cup, Indira Gandhi Gold Cup.

Q32. The Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra Award was instituted in the year 1995. Guru Kelucharan Mohapatra was recognized for which dance form?

- A) Kathak
- B) Manipuri
- C) Chhau
- D) Odissi**

Solution: 4.(d) Odissi. Awards:- Padma Vibhushan (2000), Padma Bhushan (1988), Padma Shri (1974), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1966), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1991), Kelucharan Mohapatra (1988-89). Built Srjan in 1993. Other famous personalities of Odissi (classical dance) - Raghunath Dutta, Deba Prasad Das, Pankaj Charan Das, Gangadhar Pradhan, Jhelum Paranjape, Mayadhar Raut, and Ileana Citaristi.

Q33. Which Indian state is renowned for the traditional canal irrigation method known as 'Kulh'?

- A) Himachal Pradesh**
- B) Odisha
- C) Andhra Pradesh
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 9.(a) Himachal Pradesh. Kuhl is a shallow surface channel diverting water from naturally flowing streams or springs, to cultivated fields, and mainly used for flood irrigation. Water Harvesting Structures found in other states : Kerala and Karnataka (Kattas, Surangams), Maharashtra (Bandharas and Tals), Tamil Nadu (Eris), Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh (Bundhis).

Q34. Which of the following components is NOT related to the New India Literacy Programme?

- A) Business and Enhancing skill Development**
- B) Foundational Literacy and Numeracy
- C) Critical Life Skills
- D) Basic Education

Solution: 9.(a) Implementation during five years from the FYs 2022-23 to 2026-27. Aim - Aims to cover a target of 5.00 crore non-literates in the age group of 15 years and above. The scheme has five components - Foundational Literacy and Numeracy, Critical Life Skills, Vocational Skills Development, Basic Education and Continuing Education, Vocational Skills Development, Continuing Education.

Q35. Which of the following is not a valid stroke in a swimming competition?

- A) Breast stroke
- B) Front stroke
- C) Leg stroke**
- D) Backstroke

Solution: 5.(c) Leg stroke. Breaststroke - A swimming style in which the swimmer is on their chest and the torso does not rotate. Freestyle (Front stroke): The swimmer may swim any style, except that in individual medley or medley relay events, freestyle means any style other than backstroke, breaststroke or butterfly. Backstroke - the swimmer lies on their back in the water and moves their arms and legs in a coordinated manner to propel themselves forward.

Q36. As of 2022, which Indian musician has the most number of Oscar awards?

- A) Asha Bhosle
- B) Gulzar
- C) AR Rahman**
- D) Lata Mangeshkar

Solution: 7.(c) AR Rahman. He won the award for Best Original Score and Best Original Song for the single Jai Ho in the 2009 Oscars for Danny Boyle's Slumdog Millionaire. First Indian woman to win an Oscar Was Bhanu Athaiya (1983) for the film 'Gandhi'. Other Indians who won Oscar :- Satyajit Ray, Resul Pookutty Gulzar, Kartiki Gonsalves (2023) and MM Keeravani and Chandrabose (2023). It was started in 1929 and is given by 'Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences.

Q37. The Blackbuck National Park is located in _____.

- A) Sikkim
- B) Gujarat**
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Haryana

Solution: 13.(b) Gujarat. Blackbuck National Park (Velavadar National Park) was established in 1976. Blackbuck is the state animal of three Indian states: - Punjab, Haryana and Andhra Pradesh. State and National parks:- Sikkim - Khangchendzonga. Madhya Pradesh - Bandhavgarh, Kanha, Kuno, Madhav, Panna, etc. Haryana - Kalesar, Sultanpur. Gujarat - Gir, Marine (Gulf of Kachchh), Vansda.

Q38. The appeal 'How's that?' is associated with_____.

- A) Badminton
- B) Volleyball

C) Hockey

D) Cricket

Solution: 6.(d) Cricket. Other terms: Maiden Over, Follow-on, Ashes, Catch, Bowled, Stump Out, Run Out, L.B.W., Googley, Yorker, Runner. Trophies associated with Cricket: Moin Ud Dowla Gold Cup, C.K. Naidu Trophy, Deodhar, Duleep, Rani Jhansi, Ranji. Terminologies: Hockey - Bully Sudden death, Short corner, Hat trick, Goal, Penalty Corner, Penalty Stroke, pushing. Badminton - ForeHand, Smash, Hit, Drop, Net, Double Fault, Shuttlecock, Service Court, Back Hand. Volleyball - Smash, Penetration, Deuce, Libero, Booster, Spikers.

Q39. The Birsra Munda International Hockey Stadium, the largest hockey stadium in the country, is situated in:

- A) Bhubaneswar, Odisha
- B) Jharsuguda, Odisha
- C) Cuttack, Odisha
- D) Rourkela, Odisha**

Solution: 13.(d) Rourkela, Odisha. Birsra Munda International Hockey Stadium was inaugurated on January 5, 2023. Officially recognised by Guinness Book of World Records as the world's largest fully seated hockey stadium. Seating capacity - 20,011 spectators. Other Hockey Stadiums: Chandigarh Hockey Stadium (Chandigarh), Major Dhyan Chand Stadium (Delhi), Mohali International Hockey Stadium (Punjab).

Q40. Which of the following statements is correct regarding badminton? I. At the beginning of the game of badminton and when the score is even, the server serves from the left service court. II. Server and receiver always stand in opposite service courts but on the same side.

- A) Only I
- B) Both I and II
- C) Only II
- D) Neither I nor II**

Solution: 7.(d) Neither I nor II. In badminton singles, the server always serves from the right service court when his/her score is even and in case of odd, he/she serves from the left service court. This rule ensures that both players get an equal chance to serve from both sides of the court. Badminton Tournaments: Sudirman Cup, Thomas Cup, Uber Cup, All England Open Badminton Championships, BWF World Championships.

Q41. The festival of Navroz or Nowroj is celebrated as the new year of which community?

- A) Buddhist
- B) Parsi**
- C) Sindhi
- D) Jainism

Solution: 9.(b) Parsi. Navroz Festival - celebrated in the first month of the Iranian calendar, usually beginning on 21 March. The day is also known as Jamshed-i-Nowruz after the Persian King, Jamshed, who introduced the Parsi calendar. Balban introduced the famous Persian Festival of Nauroz. Other festivals - Zarhost No Deeso, Khordad Sal and Pateti.

Q42. The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) was established in _____.

- A) 1928**
- B) 1924
- C) 1922
- D) 1926

Solution: 10.(a) 1928. BCCI - The wealthiest governing body of cricket in the world. Headquarters - Wankhede Stadium (Mumbai). Important Domestic Cricket Tournaments: Ranji Trophy, Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy, Irani Cup, Deodhar Trophy, Vijay Hazare Trophy, Duleep Trophy. ICC (International Cricket Council) - Founded - 15 June 1909, Headquarters - Dubai.

Q43. When was Kapil Dev awarded with Padma Shri Award?

- A) 1981
- B) 1980
- C) 1982**
- D) 1983

Solution: 11.(c) 1982. Kapil Dev (The Haryana Hurricane) : He was the captain of the Indian cricket team when India lifted a World Cup trophy (1983). Awards - Padma Bhushan (1991), Arjuna Award for Cricket (1979), C. K. Nayudu Lifetime Achievement Award (2013).

Q44. 'Galpaguchchha', written by Rabindranath Tagore is a collection of _____.

- A) devotional songs
- B) poems
- C) English shayaris
- D) short stories**

Solution: 10.(d) Short stories. Galpaguchchha is a collection of sixty-one of Tagore's short stories. Other short stories by Tagore - "Kabuliwala", "Kshudita Pashan". Some novels - Chaturanga, Shesher Kobita, Char Odhay, and Noukadubi. Poetry - Gitanjali (Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913).

Q45. "Ambubachi Mela" is held in which place?

- A) Patna
- B) Lucknow
- C) Pune
- D) Guwahati**

Solution: 5.(d) Guwahati (Assam). Ambubachi Mela also known as Ameti or Tantric fertility festival. It is the celebration of the yearly menstruation (phallus worship - worship of sexual organ) course of goddess Kamakhya. Kamakhya temple is located on Nilachal Hills on the banks of Brahmaputra river. It is built on Nilachala Style of Architecture. Other festivals and melas of Assam :- Bihu, Me-Dum-Me-Phi, Majuli, Dehing Patkai, Kaziranga Elephant, Ali Ai Ligang, Junbeel Mela, Rongker & Chomangkan, Raas Lila, Karam Puja, Baishagu.

Q46. Indian festival Dussehra is a famous celebration that takes place at which of the following?

- A) Mysore Palace**
- B) Nizam Palace
- C) Mayurbhanj Palace
- D) Jaipur Palace

Solution: 7.(a) Mysore Palace (Karnataka). Established - 1912, Started construction in 1897. It was the residence of Wodeyars rulers who ruled Mysore for seven centuries. Nizam Palace (Kolkata) - It was constructed in 1933. Mayurbhanj Palace - The first phase of construction began in 1804 by King Rajeshwari Sumitra Devi Bhanjdeo and was later fully developed by Maharaja Krishnachandra Bhanjdeo, Sriramchandra Bhanjdeo and Maharaja Pratap Chandra. Jaipur Palace - Construction started in 1729 and completed in 1732 during the reign of Jai Singh II.

Q47. With reference to Manipuri classical dance, which of the following statements is correct? a) Lai Haraoba is the earliest form of Manipuri dance. b) Ras, Sankirtana and Thang-Ta are the most popular forms of this dance. c) Manipuri dance has its origin in the Jain traditional dance form.

- A) a, b, c
- B) Both a and c
- C) Both a and b**
- D) Both b and c

Solution: 3.(c) Both a and b. Manipuri Dance: Classical dance forms of India and noted for themes based on Vaishnavism and spectacular execution of 'Ras Lila' (dance dramas based on love between Radha and Krishna). Guru Bipin Singh: Regarded as the "Father of the Manipuri Dance". Famous dancers - Nirmala Mehta, Charu Mathur, Darshana Jhaveri, Devyani Chalia.

Q48. Which Indian state was the first to make it mandatory for all homes to have rooftop rainwater harvesting structures?

- A) Sikkim
- B) Tamil Nadu**
- C) Odisha
- D) Haryana

Solution: 5.(b) Tamil Nadu. Rooftop rainwater harvesting is a technique used for the conservation of water. The rainwater that has fallen on the roof of

houses or buildings is collected in storage or underground tanks through the help of pipes in this technique. This helps in recharging the groundwater levels. Rainwater harvesting is already a common practice in Mizoram.

Q49. _____ is a festival of sowing seeds in the field. It is a major festival celebrated in Jharkhand.

- A) Karam
- B) Bandana
- C) Jawa
- D) Rohini**

Solution: 11.(d) Rohini. Festivals like Rajsawala Ambavati and Chitgomha are also celebrated with Rohini. Tribal festivals of Jharkhand - Karma, Sarhul, Akhain Jatra or Hal Punhya, Bhagta Parab, Karam, Bandna, Tusu or Makar.

Q50. Which of the following festivals is mainly associated with Manipur?

- A) Yaoshang**
- B) Hareli
- C) Baisakhi
- D) Wangala

Solution: 1.(a) Youshang - A five-day event celebrated on the full moon day of the month of Lamda (February-March). It is indigenous tradition of the Meitei people. Manipur Festivals: Lai Haraoba, Kang Festival, Heirku Hindongba, Chavang Kut, Sangai, Ningol Chakouba, Chumpha, Lui Ngai Ni.

Q51. Padma Bhushan awardee of 2004 and classical dancer Alarmel Valli is known for performing which dance form?

- A) Odissi
- B) Bharatanatyam**
- C) Chhau
- D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 11.(b) Bharatnatyam is a major form of Indian classical dance that originated in Tamil Nadu. Alarmel Valli was the second youngest dancer to be conferred the Padma Shri (1991), after Vyjayanthimala. Some of the famous classical dancers are : Bharatanatyam - Rukmini Devi Arundale, Padma Subrahmanyam, Vyjayanthimala. Kathak - Birju Maharaj, Nahid Siddiqui, Lacchu Maharaj, Gopi Krishna, Saswati Sen, Manjari Chaturvedi. Kathakali - Kalamandalam Krishnan Nair. Odissi - Kelucharan Mohapatra, Madhavi Mudgal, Sharmila Mukherjee.

Q52. Rani - Ki - Vav (the Queen's stepwell) is situated on the banks of which river?

- A) Ganga
- B) Yamuna
- C) Krishna
- D) Saraswati**

Solution: 12.(d) Saraswati. Rani-ki-Vav (UNESCO World Heritage Site) - Its construction is attributed to Udayamati (the spouse of the 11th-century Chaulukya king Bhima - 1) in Patan (Gujarat). It is on the new 100 rupee note (coloured Lavender). The Saraswati River is a deified river first mentioned in the Rigveda and later in Vedic and post-Vedic texts.

Q53. Mallika Sarabhai received the prestigious _____ award by Government of India in the year 2010.

- A) Padma Bhushan**
- B) Padma Vibhushan
- C) Jnanpith
- D) Bharat Ratna

Solution: 3.(a) Padma Bhushan. Mallika Sarabhai (Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dancer): Honour - Government of Gujarat awarded her with 'Gaurav Puraskar' for her contribution in the field of drama and dance. The French Government awarded her with a knight's rank in the Order of Academic Palms in 2005. Famous Bharatanatyam dancers - Yamini Krishnamurthy, Padma Subrahmanyam, Mrinalini Sarabhai, Balasaraswati.

Q54. Raut Nacha is a famous folk dance form of _____ state of india.

- A) Chhattisgarh**
- B) Sikkim

- C) Punjab
D) Karnataka

Solution: 1.(a) Chhattisgarh. Other dances here - Saila, Karma, Sua Nacha, Panthi, Gendi. Sikkim - Singhi Chaam, Gha To Kito, Maruni, Tamang Selo, Yak Cham, Ghantu. Punjab - Bhangra, Giddha, Luddi, Sammi. Karnataka - Yakshagana, Dollu Kunita, Gaarudi Gombe, Nagamandala, Joodu Haligi. Assam - Bihu, Bhortal, Bagurumba.

Q55. Pandavani Folk singer_____ is a Padma Bhushan Awardee of 2003.

- A) Sulakshana Pandit
B) Teejan Bai
C) Mamta Chandrekar
D) Ila Arun

Solution: 2.(b) Teejan Bai (Chhattisgarh). She has been awarded Padma Vibhushan (2019), Padma Shri (1988), Sangeet Natak Academy award (1995). Pandavani: Folk singing style that involves the narration of tales from the Mahabharata. Proponents associated with Pandavani: Punaram Nishad, Chetan Dewangan, and Jhaduram Dewangan, Ritu Verma, etc.

Q56. Bhimsen Joshi was one of the greatest Indian vocalists from _____ in the Hindustani classical tradition.

- A) Karnataka**
B) Tamil Nadu
C) Maharashtra
D) Kerala

Solution: 14.(a) Karnataka. Bhimsen Joshi belongs to the Kirana Gharana tradition of Hindustani Classical Music. Award - Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1998), Bharat Ratna (2008). Girija Devi - Uttar Pradesh, representing the Banaras gharana. Pandit Jasraj - Haryana, representing Mewati Gharana.

Q57. Pandit Birju Maharaj was an Indian dancer, composer, singer, and exponent of the _____ "Kalka-Bindadin" Gharana of Kathak dance in India.

- A) Lucknow**
B) Hyderabad
C) Agra
D) Gwalior

Solution: 3.(a) Lucknow. Pandit Birju Maharaj (Awards): Padma Vibhushan (1986), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1964), Kalidas Samman (1987). Famous Kathak personalities: Janaki Prasad (Benaras Gharana), Ishwari Prasad (Lucknow Gharana), Shambhu Maharaj (Lucknow Gharana), Raja Chakradhar Singh (Raigarh Gharana).

Q58. How many field players are in a football team?

- A) 11**
B) 14
C) 12
D) 13

Solution: 8.(a) 11 - Divided into the goalkeeper(1), defenders(3-5), midfielders and forwards. A team will also need to play with less than 11 if one or more of their players get sent off during the match after seeing a red card for Offenses committed during the game. Number of players in other games :- Badminton - 2 or 4, Baseball - 9, Basketball - 5, Hockey - 11, Kabaddi - 7, Kho -Kho - 9, Polo - 4.

Q59. How many countries are part of SAARC?

- A) 8**
B) 2
C) 5
D) 7

Solution: 6.(a) 8. South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) : Established in - 1985. Objective - Advance social improvement, economic growth, and cultural development throughout South Asia. Headquarters - Kathmandu, Nepal. Member Countries - Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka. Afghanistan joined as the 8th member of SAARC in 2007.

Q60. In Cricket, if the umpire extends both hands horizontally it means_____.

- A) dead ball
B) no ball
C) run out
D) wide ball

Solution: 8.(d) Wide ball. Umpire Signal: If a batsman is out, the umpire signals him by raising his hand and index finger. If a batsman is "NOT OUT" the umpire signals by shaking his hands or clearly saying "not out". When a batsman hits a ball beyond the boundary line, the umpire indicates a six by raising both hands above their head. The umpire signal's leg bye by touching the raised knee. A 'no ball' is called if a bowler has overstepped the popping crease. This is signalled by an arm raised at shoulder height.

Q61. Navreh is the lunar new year that is celebrated in which of the following states/union territories?

- A) Sikkim
B) Assam
C) Manipur
D) Jammu and Kashmir

Solution: 14.(d) Jammu and Kashmir. Navreh - It falls on the first day of the Chaitra Navratri. On this day Kashmiri pandits look at a bowl of rice which is considered as a symbol of riches and fertility. Traditional New Year Festivals: Puthandu (Tamil Nadu), Bihu (Assam), Vishu (Kerala, Karnataka and Pondicherry).

Q62. The High court of Delhi was established in _____.

- A) 1962
B) 1947
C) 1951
D) 1966

Solution: 15.(d) 1966. The High Court of Delhi was established with four Judges. They were Chief Justice K.S.Hegde, Justice I.D. Dua, Justice H.R.Khanna and Justice S.K.Kapur. Presently, the sanctioned strength of Judges of the High Court of Delhi is 45 permanent Judges and 15 Additional Judges. Chief Justice of Delhi High court (As of June 2023) - Satish Chandra Sharma. Before 1966 under the States Reorganization Act, 1956 Delhi was under the jurisdiction of the Punjab High Court.

Q63. Who has been appointed as the second Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) in India ?

- A) Admiral R Hari Kumar
B) General Manoj Pande
C) General Manoj Mukund Naravane
D) Lt. General Anil Chauhan

Solution: 13.(d) Lt. General Anil Chauhan. The post of Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) was created in 2019 on the recommendations of a defense expert committee headed by Lt. General D.B. Shekatkar. General Bipin Rawat was the first CDS of India.

Q64. What is the classical dance of Assam?

- A) Sattriya Nritya**
B) Bharatnatyam
C) Kathak
D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 4.(a) Sattriya Nritya originated in Sattri, monastery, as a part of neo-Vaishnavite movement started by Srimanta Sankardev in Assam, in the 15th Century. It was given the status of a classical dance in the year 2000 by the Sangeet Natak Akademi. Other classical dances of India: Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Manipuri (Manipur) and Odissi (Odisha).

Q65. The musical instrument Sarod is associated with:

- A) Zakir Hussain
B) Allahrakha
C) Amjad Ali Khan
D) Khayyam

Solution: 15.(c) Amjad Ali Khan. Awards : Sangeet Natak Academy Award (1989), Padma Shri (1975), Padma Bhushan (1991) and Padma Vibhushan (2001). Other Sarod players : Ali Akbar khan, Allauddin khan, Bahadur khan, Abhishek Lahiri and Rajeew Taranath. Zakir Hussain (Tabla), Ustad Alla Rakha Khan (Tabla).

Q66. Pannalal Ghosh is famous for which musical instrument ?

- A) Shehnai
- B) Tabla
- C) Ghatam
- D) Flute**

Solution: 12.(d) Flute. Other Flute players in India: Hariprasad Chaurasia, Ronu Majumdar, Rajendra Prasanna, Pravin Godkhindi. Shehnai players: Bismillah Khan, Ali Ahmed Hussain Khan. Tabla players: Zakir Hussain, Kishan Maharaj, Alla Rakha. Ghatam player: Thetakudi Harihara Vinayakram.

Q67. Which Indian musician is the first singer to get the highest civilian honour, the Bharat Ratna ?

- A) Zakir Hussain
- B) A.R. Rahman
- C) M.S. Subbulakshmi**
- D) R.D. Burman

Solution: 1.(c) M.S. Subbulakshmi. Her awards: Bharat Ratna (1998), Padma Vibhushan (1975), Padma Bhushan (1954), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Carnatic Music - Vocal (1956). Bharat Ratna Award was instituted in 1954.

Q68. The music legend Jagjit Singh is associated with:

- A) Ghazal**
- B) Classical Music
- C) Western Music
- D) Instrument

Solution: 3.(a) Ghazal (a form of amatory poem or ode, originating in Arabic poetry). Awards - Padma Bhushan (2003), Rajasthan Ratna (2012), Lata Mangeshkar Samman (1998), Sahitya Academy Award (1998), Sahitya Kala Academy Award by Rajasthan government (1998). Other Ghazal Singers: Hariharan, Pankaj Udhas, Talat Aziz, Anup Jalota, Farida Khanum, Ustad Mehndi Hasan, Ghulam Ali.

Q69. Name the Indo-Persian Dance form from Uttar Pradesh.

- A) Kathak**
- B) Garba
- C) Chhau
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 11.(a) Kathak. Some important dances and their related states: Garba (Gujarat), Chhau (Jharkhand, West Bengal and Odisha, Kathakali (Kerala), Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Sattriya (Assam).

Q70. Ranjumoni Saikia was awarded the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award 2019 for her contribution to which classical dance?

- A) Kuchipudi
- B) Mohiniyattam
- C) Sattriya**
- D) Chhau

Solution: 10.(c) Sattriya (Classical dance of Assam). Exponents - Guru Jatin Goswami, Manik Barbayan, Ghanakanta Bora. Other dances and their exponents : Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh) - Indrani Bajpai, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Raja Radha Reddy, Swapna Sundari, and Mallika Sarabhai. Mohiniyattam (Kerala) - Sunanda Nair, Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, Radha Dutta, Vijayalakshmi, Gopika Varma. Chhau (West Bengal) -

Gambhir Singh Mura.

Q71. Which of the following terms is NOT related with cricket ? I. Eagle II. Basket

- A) Neither I nor II
- B) Only I
- C) Only II
- D) Both I and II**

Solution: 14.(d) Both I and II. The term Eagle is related to Golf sports. The term "basket" is related to Basketball. Terminologies related to Cricket: Wicket, Bouncer, Batsman, Bowler, Century, All Out, All-rounder, Bye, Catch, etc.

Q72. Pola festival is associated with which of the following states.

- A) Maharashtra**
- B) Mizoram
- C) Nagaland
- D) Karnataka

Solution: 10.(a) Maharashtra. Pola is a festival of the state of Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh which is celebrated by the farmers by the worship of the bull. Important Festival and their state: Lohri, Baisakhi (Punjab). Gangaur, Teej, Bundi (Rajasthan). Losar, Saga Dawa (Sikkim). Pongal, Thaipusam, Natyanjali Festival (Tamil Nadu). Chhath Puja, Bihula (Bihar). Baisakhi (Haryana). Onam, Vishu (Kerala). Ganesh Utsav, Gudi Padva (Maharashtra). Durga Puja (West Bengal).

Q73. Padma Subrahmanyam received Padma Bhushan Award for her contribution to Indian Classical dance form in .

- A) 1998
- B) 2003**
- C) 2001
- D) 2010

Solution: 1.(b) 2003. Dr. Padma Subrahmanyam is a leading figure in Indian BharataNatyam classical dance. Awards - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1983), Padma Shri (1981), Nehru Award (1983), Kerala Nishagandhi Puraskaram (2015).

Q74. Pandit Kishan Maharaj was a famous Indian _____ player.

- A) Sitar
- B) Sarangi
- C) Flute
- D) Tabla**

Solution: 4.(d) Tabla. Pandit Kishan Maharaj - belonged to the Benares gharana of Hindustani classical music. Awards - Padma Shri in 1973 and the Padma Vibhushan in 2002. Famous Players : Tabla - Zakir Hussain, Trilok Gurtu, Talvin Singh, Anindo Chatterjee. Sitar - Ravi Shankar, Anoushka Shankar, Annapurna Devi. Flute - Hariprasad Chaurasia, Pravin Godkhindi, Ronu Majumdar, Sarangi - Abdul Latif Khan, Ustad Faiyaz Khan.

Q75. Which among the following dance forms of India is associated with Rajasthan ?

- A) Kalbelia**
- B) Bharatanatyam
- C) Odissi
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 2.(a) Kalbelia (Snake Charmer Dance). Only performed by women while the men play the "khanjari" and the "poongi"(traditionally played to capture snakes) instrument. UNESCO list of Intangible Cultural Heritage (2010). Other folk dances of Rajasthan - Ghumar, Chakri, Ganagor, Jhulan Leela, Jhuma, Suisini and Ghapal. Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu). Odissi (Odisha). Kathakali (Kerala)